SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #60 · FAITH & BELIEF

“Real faith means never feeling afraid.”

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Where it often comes from

Hearing “Fear not” verses used to shame you for feeling afraid. Anxiety that feels like spiritual failure. Being told that fear is the opposite of faith. Comparing yourself with people who seem fearless. Not knowing that fear is a normal human response that God addresses with comfort.

What Scripture teaches

God often says “Do not fear” because He knows we feel afraid. These words are comfort, not condemnation. David said, “I will fear no evil, for You are with me,” in the valley of the shadow of death. When Peter was afraid and began to sink, Jesus immediately reached out and caught him. Faith is not the absence of fear; it is turning to God when we are afraid.

> *“Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness”* **(Isaiah 41:10)**.

Also see

> “I sought the LORD, and He answered me; He delivered me from all my fears” **(Psalm 34:4)**.

> “But when he saw the strength of the wind, he was afraid, and beginning to sink, cried out, ‘Lord, save me!’ Immediately Jesus reached out His hand and took hold of Peter. ‘You of little faith,’ He said, ‘why did you doubt?’” **(Matthew 14:30–31)**.

> “Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for You are with me; Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me” **(Psalm 23:4)**.

> “Peace I leave with you; My peace I give to you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled; do not be afraid” **(John 14:27)**.

Common self-statements

- If I had real faith, I wouldn’t be afraid.
- My anxiety is a sin.
- God is disappointed when I’m scared.
- I have to hide my fear from other Christians.
- Being afraid means I don’t trust God.
- Strong Christians are never anxious.

Common logical errors

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you are either fearless or faithless.
- **Should statements:** “I should never feel afraid.”
- **Misreading Scripture:** Hearing “Do not fear” as a scolding instead of a comfort.
- **Labeling:** Calling yourself faithless because you feel anxious.

Challenging questions

- Why does God so often say “Do not fear”?
- What did Jesus do when Peter was afraid and sinking?
- Did David feel no fear, or did he trust God in it?
- Is fear a sin, or a feeling I can bring to God?
- What does Psalm 34:4 say happened when David sought the LORD?
- Could anxiety have physical or emotional causes I can address?
- What is one fear I can bring to God right now?

Truth summary

> Real faith does not mean never feeling afraid. God says “Do not fear” to comfort me, because He knows I am afraid. When I am afraid, I can turn to Him. He is with me, He strengthens me, and He holds me with His right hand. Faith is trusting God in my fear.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Faith
- Peace
- Protection

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Real faith means never feeling afraid"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Real faith means never feeling afraid." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Why does God often say "Do not fear"?
- ☐ What did Jesus do when Peter was afraid?
- ☐ Did David trust God in his fear?
- ☐ Is fear a sin or a feeling to bring to God?
- ☐ What happened when David sought the LORD?
- ☐ What fear can I bring to God now?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ "Do not fear" is God's comfort, not His scolding.
- ☐ God is with me when I am afraid.
- ☐ Faith is trusting God in my fear.
- ☐ Jesus reaches out to catch me when I sink.
- ☐ God delivers me from all my fears.
- ☐ Jesus gives me His peace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Isaiah 41:10**
  "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness."
- [ ] **Psalm 34:4**
  "I sought the LORD, and He answered me; He delivered me from all my fears."
- [ ] **Matthew 14:30–31**
  "But when he saw the strength of the wind, he was afraid, and beginning to sink, cried out, 'Lord, save me!' Immediately Jesus reached out His hand and took hold of Peter. 'You of little faith,' He said, 'why did you doubt?'"
- [ ] **Psalm 23:4**
  "Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for You are with me; Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me."
- [ ] **John 14:27**
  "Peace I leave with you; My peace I give to you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled; do not be afraid."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Fear to faith log:** Each time I feel afraid, write the fear and one sentence of trust: "When I am afraid, I trust You."
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Isaiah 41:10 becomes: "**Sarah**, do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Matthew 14:22–33,** and write what Jesus did the moment Peter cried out.
- ☐ **When fear comes, breathe slowly for one minute and pray Isaiah 41:10,** then take one small step forward.
- ☐ **Face one small fear this week** with God's help, and write what actually happened.
- ☐ **If anxiety is frequent or strong,** talk with a doctor or Christian counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Real faith means never feeling afraid": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One fear I brought to God
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Real faith means never feeling afraid.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You comfort me when I am afraid. Help me reject the lie that real faith means never feeling afraid. When fear comes, help me turn to You. Strengthen me, help me, and hold me with Your right hand. Give me Your peace. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.